



Classes 6 to 12. One unique aspect of the curriculum is the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) for personalised feedback. The teaching module has PPTs, video presentations and interactive sessions, during which students can clear their doubts about the lessons taught.

The AI tool is embedded in the app. It analyses a student's performance, maps that against the curriculum and benchmarks it against district and country data. It also generates unique actionable feedback for each student that helps the child with preparations for examinations.

The Smart Classes programme runs on digital platforms as well, and it has reached over 1,30,000 students through YouTube. Under the Gyanodaya initiative, an effort is being made to address some of the key concerns of government schools in Godda – low student count, high dropout rates and lack of subject-specific teachers.

Local drives and campaigns are organized from time to time to encourage students and family members to ensure regularity in schools.

Godda resident Karishma met a few members of the Gyanodaya team in 2022 during one such initiative called "Back to School". She was studying in Class 8 at the Middle School, Manikpur. Her father Madhusudan Pandit is a farm worker and the only bread earner for their family of six. Karishma's parents were struggling with their children's education. And Karishma herself was losing interest in studies. She would miss school

often. Once the Gyanodaya team members came to know about this, they interacted with Karishma and her family.

"There is staff crunch at the school and because of that, many students end up skipping classes," said Mrs Ranu, the nodal teacher of Gyanodaya Smart Classes at the Middle School, Manikpur. "We kept talking to students who were irregular and tried to convince them. We also interacted with their families. Our team noticed that many students were showing interest in the Smart Classes modules – especially for science. In the absence of dedicated science teachers, the children benefited a lot from the virtual classes," she added.

Karishma is one such student. She said she enjoys Smart Classes and has a good attendance record in school now. "Science is my favourite subject. I want to take it up for higher studies," said the 15-year-old girl.

Rakesh Kumar Yadav, a student of Class 10, had a similar experience. At one point in time, his school, High School, Devanchok, had only three teachers for Classes 1 to 8. "Not all subjects could be taught because we did not have enough teachers in the school," he said. Covering the syllabus was a major challenge for both the teachers and the students. "But Smart Classes helped us a lot. For me, the most important part in the Smart Classes module is the weekly tests on each lesson we cover," Rakesh said, adding that they help him prepare on time and be consistent.

Rakesh's family has always been supportive of his education, and the teenager's neighbour has also extended a helping hand. "We don't have a smart phone in my house. When I told this to my neighbor, he said I could use his phone to access the online teaching modules. Thanks to him, now I can refer to the classes whenever I need," the teenager said.

Since 2018, when the initiative was launched in Godda, the district's education ranking has improved. In 2018, Godda ranked last among the 24 districts in Jharkhand, according to the Jharkhand Autonomous Council. Currently, it is at the 11th spot in the state. Gyanodaya has six major segments – teaching modules for Classes 6 to 12, board examinations, IIT, JEE, NEET exam preparation modules and general competitive examination modules. Over the years, Gyanodaya has bagged several awards and honours, including the ICC Social Impact Award in 2021 for providing quality education in remotest and untapped villages of Godda through smart learning and accolades from the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). Gyanodaya Godda also got the National Award for E-Governance in 2022 during the 24th National E-Governance Conference in Hyderabad. Under the Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan, 1,854 government schools in all aspirational districts of Jharkhand have been upgraded with ICT labs and 1,000 Smart Classes based on the Godda Gyanodaya model.

